

Monitors

Aperture-grille Mask

With an aperture-grille mask, images are made up of vertical groupings of red, blue, and green phosphor stripes instead of dots. Aperture-grille monitors have two barely-visible wires going across the screen to help stabilise the image.

Aspect Ratio

The ratio of a monitor's height to its width. The typical aspect ratio for a monitor is 4 to 3, or 1.33. For example, $640/480 = 1.33$.

Bandwidth

A qualitative term describing the video amplifier's potential performance. The higher the pixel rate (or format number), the higher the bandwidth required of the video amplifier.

Contrast

The ratio between the maximum and the minimum luminance values of the display.

Contrast Control

A manual control for a monitor that affects both luminance and contrast.

Colour Balance

The ability of the monitor to show and maintain the same colour when switching or varying the intensity of the screen.

Refresh Rate

The number of times per second that a device such as a CRT is re-energised. This is an ergonomic issue directly related to long term ease of use. A higher refresh rate translates into a more flicker-free display.

Resolution

The number of pixel or dots per frame (DPI).